

Gasoline engine

This is a model of an internal combustion engine, just like those used in most cars today. Fuel is constantly drawn into the engine's cylinder where it is set afire by an electric spark. The explosion pushes the piston down and turns the engine.

Fuel is drawn into the engine through this inlet pipe.

This is the spark plug that lights the fuel.

This is the cylinder where the fuel is burned.

Old burned fuel is pushed out through this exhaust pipe.

This is the piston. It has been pushed down by the burning fuel.

Cooling fins

Spot the engine

You can find a machine's engine in all sorts of places. The engines here are colored green.



Electric car



Magnet-powered train



Propeller aircraft

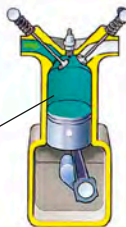


Jet fighter

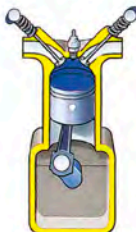
Four steps

In most cars, the engine works in four steps, which is why it is called a 4-stroke engine.

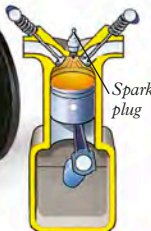
Cylinder



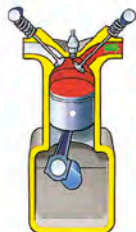
1. Fuel and air pass into the cylinder.



2. The fuel and air are squashed.



3. The spark sets fire to the fuel.



4. The burned gases are pushed out.